CAKES · SWEET

Pavlova

Crisp meringue shell with a soft center, dried low and slow.

SERVES 8–10 · ACTIVE 20 MIN · TOTAL 4 HR
PAN BAKING SHEET (8–9 IN ROUND) · OVEN 350°F → 200°F

BEFORE YOU START

- Egg whites at room temperature; bowl and whisk totally free of fat or yolk
- No superfine sugar? Pulse granulated sugar in a food processor a few times
- Line the sheet with parchment or a silicone mat; don't grease it
- Save the 4 yolks for lemon curd

INGREDIENTS

Meringue

120 g	4 large	Egg whites room temp
200 g	1 cup	Superfine sugar
	1 tsp	Pure vanilla extract
	1/2 tsp	Cream of tartar
	1 tsp	Cornstarch

Toppings

to taste	Whipped cream
optional	Lemon curd
to taste	Fresh berries or fruit

METHOD

Meringue

1. Heat the oven to **350°F**. (You'll drop it to **200°F** the moment the pavlova goes in.)
2. Whip the whites on medium-high to soft peaks.
   WAIT ~5 MIN
3. Add the sugar in two parts, beating about **30 sec** after each. Then go to high speed.
   WAIT ~2 MIN
   ✓ *Glossy, stiff peaks that don't move when the whisk is held upright*
4. Beat in the vanilla for **1 minute**. If the peaks have softened, keep beating.
5. Gently fold in the cream of tartar and cornstarch with a spatula.

Shape & bake

6. Spread into an 8–9 in circle with tall edges and a clear hollow in the center. Swirl peaks with the back of a spoon if you like.
7. Put it in the oven and immediately turn the heat down to **200°F**. Rotate once if spots start browning; otherwise keep the door shut.
   WAIT ~90 MIN
   ✓ *Firm and dry to the touch, and still pale*
8. Turn the oven off and let the pavlova cool completely inside it. The slow cool keeps cracking down.

Finish

9. Right before serving, pile on whipped cream, curd, and fruit. Slice and serve.

NOTES

Make ahead & storage

- Plain, cooled shell keeps up to **2 days** at room temp in an airtight container
- Best eaten right after topping; doesn't freeze well

Substitutions

- Acid: 1 tsp white vinegar, cider vinegar, or lemon juice instead of cream of tartar. The source notes a little more spread with liquid acid.
- Minis: portion into 6 nests with centers hollowed. Same **350°F** start, then **~35–40 min** at **200°F** (readers report they may need longer).

Pairs with

- Lemon Curd (uses the 4 leftover yolks)

My notes

- Humid days slow the whipping and drying; plan extra oven time

CAKES
SWEET
GLUTEN-FREE · FRUIT · MAKE-AHEAD · USES EGG WHITES
SUMMER

Adapted from Sally's Baking Addiction — sallysbakingaddiction.com/pavlova. Method rewritten and condensed for personal kitchen use.